At present the temple is in ruins but the *jagamohana* is quite intact. Though in ruins, it testifies its fomer grandeur unrivalled by any other temple in the world. Grand in its conception, great in its beauty, and high in its stature, it stands out as the most notable marvel of Odishan art.

Several other subsidiary structures are also found within the enclosed area of the rectangular *prakara*. Among them, the Mayadevi and Vaishnava brick temples are worth mentioning.

Mayadevi Temple: To the west of the main temple is the remains of temple No.2, popularly called the temple of Mayadevi, believed to be one of the wives of Surya. But the presence of the sun images as *parsvadevata* in situ indicates its dedication to the Sungod, built earlier than the main Sun temple. The temple facing east consists of a *deul* (sanctum)and a *jagamohana* (porch)standing over a raised platform, facade of which is relieved with ornamentation. The superstructures of the sanctum and porch are missing. The interior of the porch is notable for its sculptural treatment while the sanctum is devoid of any deity. Stylistically, the temple is assignable to *circa* late eleventh century A.D.

Vaishnava Temple: The small brick temple facing east, located in the south-west corner of the compound was discovered in 1956 during the sand clearance work. Also called temple No.3, it is *pancharatha* on plan. It consists of a *deul* and a *jagamohana* but the superstructure is missing and is also devoid of any exterior decorations. Images of Balarama and two *parsvadevatas* ie; Varaha and Trivikrama were unearthed (now displayed in Archaeological Museum, Konark) which speaks about its Vaishnava affiliation. The temple is datable to circa eleventh century A.D.

The monument and museum remains open from sunrise to 8 PM. Common entry fee valid for both monument and Museum. For an Indian citizen is Rs.10.00 and for a foreign visitor is Rs. 250.00 or US $ 5.00 while children below 15 years are not required to pay any entry fee.

For any suggestions/complaints please contact:

Asst. Superintending Archaeologist
Archaeological Museum,
Konark - 752111
Tele/Fax : 06758-236822
or
Senior Conservation Assistant
(Site Incharge)
Sun Temple
Konark Sub-Circle, Konark
Ph. / Fax : 06758-236459

(For free distribution only)

SUN TEMPLE, KONARK

Dist. Puri, Odisha



प्रत्नकीर्तिमपावृणु

भारत सरकार

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

अधीक्षण पुरातत्वविद्

SUPERINTENDING ARCHAEOLOGIST

भारतीय पुरातत्व सर्वेक्षण

ARCHAEOLOGICAL SURVEY OF INDIA

भुवनेश्वर मंडल, तोशाली आपार्टमेंट ब्लाक-VI(B)

सत्यनगर, भुवनेश्वर - 751007(ओडीशा)

BHUBANESWAR CIRCLE, TOSHALI APARTMENT
BLOCK-VI(B), SATYA NAGAR,
BHUBANESWAR - 751007 (ODISHA)

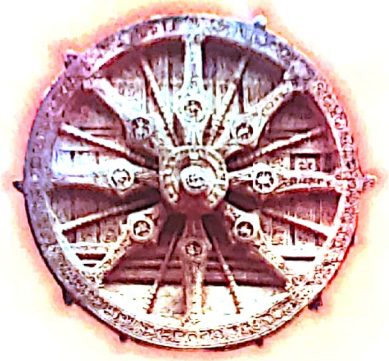
Scanned with OKEN Scanner

SUN TEMPLE
KONARK

Konark (Lat. 19°53' N, Long. 86° 06' E); a small village to the south of Mahanadi delta in Puri district is situated on the east coast of India. It owes its singular distinction to the Sun temple. The place is well connected by all weather motorable road either from Bhubaneswar (65km) or from Puri (40km).

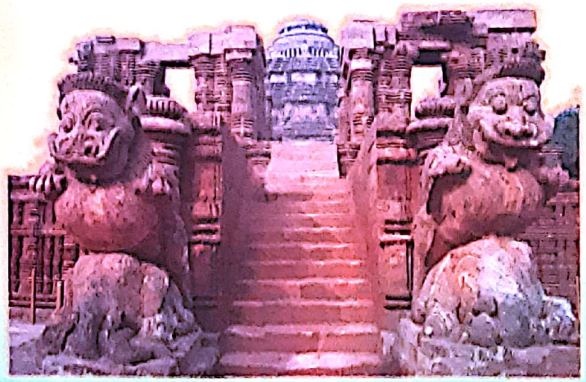
It is one of the principle *kshetras* mentioned in the *Kapila Samhita*. It is also known as *Padma-Kshetra* or *Arka-Kshetra*. The term Konark is attributed to the words *Kona* and *Arka*, meaning corner and sun respectively; hence the etymology 'corner sun'.

Built in the thirteenth century A.D. by the king Narasimhadeva-1 (1238-1264 A.D) of the Ganga dynasty, the patron deity of this temple was Sun or *Arka*.The image of Sun was worshipped in the *garbhagriha*. Now it is no more. The temple stands on the shore of Bay of Bengal and gets the first rays of the rising sun on its main entrance. The European mariners called the temple "Black pagoda", which helped them as a land mark during their sea voyages. This great edifice has been included in the list of World Heritage monuments by UNESCO in 1984.



The temple marks the culmination of art and architecture of medieval Orissa. The temple resembles a colossal chariot with 12 pair of wheels lavishly sculpted with symbolic motifs and is pulled away by seven spirited horses. The temple comprises of several distinct and well organized special units viz; the *deul* or the sanctum surmounted by a high *shikhara* which no longer exists; the *jagamohana* or audience hall, which is presently sealed and filled with sand and rubbles and the detached *natamandira* or dancing hall on a high platform,now without a roof. In front of the eastern flights of steps of the *jagamohana*, was originally installed the *Arunastambha*. The pillar has been shifted to Puri by the Marathas for installation of the same in front of the *simhadwar* of Jagannath temple, Puri.

While laterite is used in the foundation, core areas and for the *prakara*, the outer surface of the temple is veneered with khondalite. The sculptures have been chiseled out of khondalite and chlorite.The sanctum, *jagamohana* and the *natamandira* are enlivened by sculptural and ornamental profusion. Mighty *gajasimhas* welcome the visitors at the porch. The sanctum displays elegant images of sun god in the three projections representing the rising sun, mid day sun and the setting sun. The roof of the *jagamohana* harbor colossal figures of female musicians. The walls of the temple contain superb carvings of divine, semi-divine, human and animal figurines amidst flora and geometric ornamentations. Different themes like agricultural practices, hunting scenes, scenes from daily life, military processions, war scenes and endless varieties of animals including the African animal giraffe are depicted. Musicians, dancers, erotic couples, vivacious *kanyas* absorbed in several gestures and actions etc. are also depicted as sculptural releifs on the walls of the temple.



Scanned with OKEN Scanner